The government has launched the AHIP scheme with the aim of constructing of one million houses forn EWS/LIG/MIG with at least 25 per cent reserved for the EWS category. The scheme aims at partnership between various agencies/government/parastatals/urban local bodies/developers for realising the goal of affordable housing for all.

Interest Subsidy Scheme for Housing the Urban Poor (ISHUP)

The ISHUP seeks to supplement the efforts of the government through the JNNURM to comprehensively address the housing shortage by providing subsidies on the bank loans forwarded for the housing to urban poor.

Integrated Low Cost Sanitation Scheme (ILCS)

The ILCS aims at conversion of individual dry latrines into pour flush latrines, thereby liberating manual scavengers from the age-old, obnoxious practice of manually carrying night soil. The guidelines were revised with effect from January 17, 2008. The scheme is on an all-town coverage basis irrespective of the population criterion and is limited to EWS households. The scheme is funded on a sharing basis, i.e., central subsidy 75 per cent, state subsidy 15 per cent, and beneficiary share 10 per cent.

SKILL DEVELOPMENT

Education and skill development play a pivotal role in economic development and growth of any country as they provide an environment for creating jobs and help in reduction of poverty and other related social fallouts. A new strategic framework for skill development for early school leavers and existing workers has been developed since ***May 2007*** in close consultation with industry, state governments, and experts.

Achievements of the National Skill Development Corporation (NSDC) upto December 2012 (in 2012-13) has been as given below –

- Approved 24 training projects for imparting skill training in a *wide array of sectors* like – healthcare; tourism; hospitality and travel; banking, financial services and insurance (BFSI); retail; IT; electronics; textiles; leather; handicrafts and automotive; agriculture, cold chains and refrigeration; tailoring; carpentry and masonry.